78. What is Medicines Sans Frontiers (MSF)?

(a) An agency formed by the International Olympic Committee (IOC) to check misuse of drugs by sportspersons

(b) A non-government organization which specializes in international humanitarian aid and emergency medical assistance

(c) An organization to develop applications of nanotechnology in medicine.

(d) An organization of medical practitioners funded by the European Union which carries out research against spread of AIDS.

Ans. (b) : Medicines Sans Frontiers (MSF) translates to Doctors without Borders. It provides medical assistance to people affected by conflict, epidemics, disasters, or exclusion from healthcare. MSF was founded in 1971 in Paris by a group of journalists and doctors.

79. In which one of the following films did the Nobel Laureate Peari S. Buck Collaborate?

(a) Shatranj Ke Khilari

(b) Guide

(c) Lawrence of Arabia

(d) Titanic

Ans. (b) : The script of the film Guide had been written by Nobel Laureate Pearl S Buck who was signed for the film perhaps for no other reason but the fact that she was a bestselling writer worldwide whose books set in China were also known in India.

80. Which one among the following was the first to legalize euthanasia?

(a) Austria (b) Switzerland

(c) Netherlands (d) Canada

Ans. (c) : The Netherlands became the first country in the world to formally legalize euthanasia, when the lower house of parliament approved a "mercy killing" Bill by a two-thirds majority.

81. Consider the following statements:

1. The agreement on South Asian Free Trade Area (SAFTA) came into effect from 1st December, 2005.

2. As per SAFTA agreement terms, India, Pakistan and Sri Lanka have to decrease their custom duties to the level of 0 to 5 percent by the year 2013.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (d) : The South Asian Free Trade Area (SAFTA) is the free trade arrangement of the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC). The agreement came into force in 2006, succeeding the 1993 SAARC Preferential Trading Arrangement. SAFTA signatory countries are Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Maldives, Nepal, Pakistan and Sri Lanka. In the first phase of the two-year period ending in 2007, SAFTA requires developing countries in South Asia (India, Pakistan and Sri Lanka) to bring their duties down to 20 percent.

82. Which one of the following pair is not correctly matched?

Recent Scientific Achivement		Country
(a) Creating the world	:	United Kingdom first mouse with a full human chromosome
(b) Cloning a human	:	Germany embryo for the first time
(c) Guiding a spacecraft	:	United States of America for collision with a comet
(d) Landing a spacecraft	:	Japan on an asteroid

Ans. (b) : Cloning a human embryo for the first time took place in U.S.A. Cloning is a process when identical types of progenies are produced from one individual.

83. Who among the following was presented with the Sangeet Natak Akademi Ratna Award, 2005 for her lifetime achievement is dance?

(a) Chandralekha

(b) Tenjavur Balasaraswati

(c) Uma Sharma

(d) Yamini Krishnamurthy

Ans. (a) : Chandralekha, Bharatnatyam dancer and Choreographer was conferred with Sangeet Natak Akademi Ratna Award, 2005 for her contribution to contemporary Indian dance.

84. Which one of the following countries is the first country in the world to propose a carbon tax for its people to address global warming?

(a) Australia (b) Germany

(c) Japan (d) New Zealand

Ans. (d) : New Zealand is the first country in the world to propose a carbon tax for its people to address global warming in the year 2005.

85. Consider the following statements:

1. Petronet LNG Ltd. is setting up another LNG terminal at Mangalore.

2. The Head Office of the Dredging Corporation of India is at Visakhapatnam.

3. The Narwapahar Mine is operated by the Uranium Corporation of India Limited.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 2, only

(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1 and 3 only

Ans. (c) : Petronet LNG Ltd. is setting up another LNG terminal at Kochi, Kerala. Hence first statement is not correct. Rest of the two statements is correct.

86. Consider the following statements in respect of welfare schemes launched by the Ministry of Rural Development, Government of India:

1. Drinking water for rural areas is one of the components of the Bharat Nirman Plan.

2. In the National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 there is a provision that the statutory minimum wage applicable to agricultural workers in the State has to be paid to the workers under the Act.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c) : Statement 1 as well as statement 2 regarding the welfare schemes launched by Ministry of Rural Development are correct.

87. What is Indo Next which was launched in January, 2005?

(a) A new scheme to promote Indian tourism

(b) A new scheme to promote export of Indian handicrafts

(c) An association of the Non-Resident Indians to organize Pravasi Bhartiya Divas every year in India

(d) An alternative trading platform being promoted by the Bombay Stock Exchange and Regional Stock Exchanges

Ans. (d) : BSE Indo Next is a joint initiative of BSE and Participating RSEs (Regional Stock Exchanges). In order to instill higher sense of involvement on the issues relating to management, business development, marketing and general operations of the BSE IndoNext platform, a "BSE Indo Next Council" has been constituted. This Council's duties have been defined in the By-laws of BSE and participating RSEs and operate under the overall supervision and control of the Governing Board of BSE.

88. In which one of the following areas did the Indira Gandhi Centre of Atomic Research make significant progress in the year 2005?

(a) Reprocessing the uranium-plutonium mixed carbide fuel of the Fast Breeder Test Reactor

(b) New applications of radioisotopes in metallurgy

(c) A new technology for production of heavy water

(d) A new technology for high level nuclear waste management

Ans. (a) : The Indira Gandhi Centre has established a comprehensive R&D infrastructure over the entire range of FBR technology, spanning reactor engineering, metallurgy and materials, chemistry of fuels and materials, fuel reprocessing and reactor safety studies. Development of the indigenous plutonium-uranium mixed carbide nuclear fuel for the fast breeder test reactor. The fuel has performed satisfactorily and produced nuclear electricity from a fast reactor for the first time in India.

89. Consider the following statements in respect of the National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 :

1. Under the provisions of the Act, 100 days of employment in a year to every household whose adult members volunteer to do unskilled manual work has become a fundamental right.

2. Under the provisions of the Act, Women are to get priority to the extent that one-half of persons who are given employment are women who have asked for work.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (d) : Both the given statements are incorrect. Provision given in statement 1 is a legal guarantee not the Fundamental Right. In statement 2 it is not 1/2 but it is 1/3 women.

90. Whom did Croatia defeat in the Davis Cup-2005 Finals to win the Davis Cup-2005?

(a) United States of America

(b) Slovak Republic

(c) Agrentina

(d) Spain

Ans. (b) : The 2005 Davis Cup was the 94th edition of the most important tournament between nations in men's tennis. The final took place on 2-4 December at the Sibamac Arena in Bratislava, Slovakia, with Croatia defeating Slovakia for their first title.

91. Indian Airlines (New name : Indian) have redesigned their logo which is a graphic wheel. This logo has been inspired from which one of the following?

(a) Hampi Temples

(b) Mamalapuram Temple

(c) Sun Temple, Konark

(d) Khajuraho Temple

Ans. (c) : After the name change to Indian, the company's aircraft sported a new look inspired by the Sun Temple at Konark in Odisha.